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(1) Research Program/Project/Study Title: Harmony in Expression: Unveiling the Lived Experiences of Maragtas Youth Performers Through Photovoice	
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Program or Project has component (if no proceed to 2)? ☐ Yes ☒ No

Component Title:	
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(2) Category (please check) ☒ Social Science/Education /Humanities & other related fields ☐ Natural/BiologicalSciences ☐ Food Research/ ☐ Developmental/ Computer/Engineering/ Architecture ☐ Extension ☐ Poster		(3) Research Center [Check the concerned center] ☒ SSITRDC Social Science and Industrial Technology Research Development Center ☐ LRDC Livestock Research Development Center ☐ FFRDC Fisheries and Food Research Development Center ☐ CSRDC Crop Science Research Development Center							
(4) Site of implementation CAPSU <table border="1" style="width: 100%;"> <tr> <td>Municipality/City:</td> <td>Pontevedra</td> </tr> <tr> <td>Province:</td> <td>Capiz</td> </tr> <tr> <td>Region:</td> <td>VI</td> </tr> </table>				Municipality/City:	Pontevedra	Province:	Capiz	Region:	VI
Municipality/City:	Pontevedra								
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(5) Classification <table border="1" style="width: 100%;"> <tr> <td>Research:</td> <td>Development:</td> </tr> <tr> <td>☒ Basic</td> <td>☐ Pilot Testing</td> </tr> <tr> <td>☐ Applied</td> <td>☐ Tech.</td> </tr> </table> Promotion/Commercialization		Research:	Development:	☒ Basic	☐ Pilot Testing	☐ Applied	☐ Tech.	(6) Mode of Implementation ☐ Single Authorship/Proponent ☐ Collaborative Research (within campus) ☒ Collaborative Research (intercampus) ☐ Collaborative Research (external agency)	
Research:	Development:								
☒ Basic	☐ Pilot Testing								
☐ Applied	☐ Tech.								
(7) Sector/Commodity Language & Culture Cultural Understanding & Preservation		(8) Discipline/Field of Specialization Development Communication English Language Teaching Literature Filipino Language Teaching							
(9) Rationale Local festivals, woven with a rich and varied tapestry of cultural expression, take center stage as student performers give life to long-standing customs. Through their intricate artistry, young talents offer a captivating collision of creative pursuit, cultural insight, and heritage preservation. Existing literature delves into the roles and perspectives of students in local festivals (Gouzouasis & Henderson, 2012; Budde & Samur, 2019; Wood & Homulja, 2021). Likewise, qualitative research inquiries leaned more on the lived experiences of festival goers (Jackson, 2014; Rahme, 2020; Bossey,									

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2022) and narrative inquiry of their stories (Boone-Smith, 2020; Ruebottom & Auste, 2018; Spring, 2014; Duerksen, 2015; Flint et al., 2022).

Substantial information is necessary to fully explore the potential of photovoice as a tool for documenting and understanding the youth performers' experiences in global and Philippine festival settings. Despite their significant role in local festivals and the preservation of cultural traditions, the involvement of performers often needs to be recognized.

Photovoice is a process in which people – usually those with limited power due to poverty, language barriers, race, class, ethnicity, gender, culture, or other circumstances – use video and/or photo images to capture aspects of their environment and experiences and share them with others. The pictures can then be used, usually with captions composed by the photographers, to bring the realities of the photographers' lives home to the public and policymakers and to spur change.

This study aims to bridge this gap and shed light on the crucial contributions of youth performers to the vitality of cultural heritage. By delving into the intricate dynamics at the intersection of youth, tradition, and cultural preservation, this research promises to offer valuable insights for both scholars and practitioners alike. For the cultural preservation advocates, this study will offer practical significance on promoting and enhancing the embedded culture in performances by understanding the lived experiences of the participants.

(9-A) Project Description

The proposed study will collaborate with the Social Science and Industrial Technology Research and Development Center. It will attempt to gain an understanding of the lived experiences of youth performers in a local festival using photovoice. Additionally, it will aim to contribute valuable insights into the cultural significance of youth performances in local festivals to foster a deeper appreciation of cultural tapestry.

(10) Statement of the Problem

This study will aim to understand how the youth performers of a local festival make sense of their lived experiences using photovoice.

Specifically, this study will seek answers to these questions:

1. What are the lived experiences of youth performers in a local festival?
2. What visual images do youth performers choose to represent their lived experiences?
3. What is the essence of the lived experiences of youth performers for them?
4. How do the youth performers enhance their understanding of cultural significance?

(11) Review of Literature

Lived Experiences of Festival Youth Performers

The young people were eager to learn about the Other by experiencing cultural differences and engaging with traditions different from theirs. In addition, they experienced the festival as an inclusive space, open for transnational identities and evoking a sense of safety and belonging. The young participants take experiences and memories of diversity as the norm rather than the exception (Dewilde et al., 2021). By representing young people's leisure spaces and activities, society's perspectives and understandings of young people are broadened. Festivals should be understood as offering a broader societal benefit beyond the festival time and space. Therefore, this work seeks to re-frame the perception of festivals and show how they can be beneficial and, although loved by many, are under-considered (Bucket-Matthews, 2018). As an unprecedented moment of large-scale unity between First and Non-First Nations Peoples in South East Australia, the Giiyong Festival elevated the value of Indigenous business, culture, and society in the regional marketplace. The performing arts, coupled with linguistic and visual idioms, worked to invigorate the Yuin cultural landscape (Ryan et al., 2021).

Festivals often consist of two types of mass events with overlapping features: the religious practices of local people, which typically culminate in the final Sunday of nine days, and a series of highly performative and often competitive events such as folklore-inflected 'street dancing', typically

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undertaken by the youth throughout the region, and performed on the streets of the city hosting the festival (Peterson, 2020).

The simplest way to think of a cultural performance is to think of its components: period, an organized program of activity, a set of performers, an audience, and a place and occasion of performance. The emergence of cultural performance as a social idiom in the social sciences, particularly in anthropology and folklore studies, and now in the humanities, especially in theatre and performance studies, paved the way for a dictum to transform culture into action. Look at Philippine cultural performances as personal creative expressions of every community member that, despite intentions, goals, and aims, become public as they are transformed from personal performances into ceremonial gatherings, sacrificial vows, and festive celebrations (Tiatco, 2019).

Photovoice

The concept of photovoice has existed for many years, but much of the theoretical background of current programs comes from the work of Caroline Wang. In 1992, Wang and Mary Ann Burris developed Photovoice based on a combination of Paulo Freire's notion of "critical consciousness" (a deep understanding of the way the world works and how society, politics, and power relationships affect one's situation); feminist theory, which emphasizes the importance of voice; and documentary photography, which is often used to help bring about social change (Center for Community Health and Development, 2023).

Wang defines five key concepts for Photovoice in Photovoice: A Participatory Action Research Strategy Applied to Women's Health, a 1999 article in the Journal of Women's Health. These five concepts include:

- Images teach
- Pictures can influence policy
- Community members ought to participate in creating and defining the images that shape healthful public policy.
- The process requires that planners bring policymakers and other influential people to the table from the outset to serve as an audience.
- Photovoice emphasizes individual and community action.

The photovoice technique has been used in many countries with people, including youth under challenging circumstances, people with disabilities and particular medical conditions (e.g., tuberculosis, HIV/AIDS), the very poor, groups subject to violence, and many others whose experiences are unknown or seemingly ignored by the community and by those in power (Center for Community Health and Development, 2023).

(12) Scientific Basis/Theoretical Framework

This study will be anchored on the basic tenets of Husserl's transcendental phenomenology, wherein no assumptions should inform phenomenology's inquiry, no philosophical or scientific theory, no deductive logic procedures, and no other empirical science or psychological speculations should inform the inquiry. Instead, the focus should be on what is given directly to an individual's intuition (Moran, 2002). The challenge is to engage in the study of a person's lived experience of a phenomenon that highlights the universal essence of that phenomenon (Lopez & Willis, 2004).

The ontological assumptions of transcendental phenomenology dictate that reality is internal to the knower and what appears in their consciousness. The essence of its epistemological assumptions emphasizes that the observer must separate himself from the world, including his physical being, to reach the state of the transcendental I and understand the phenomenon by descriptive means (Neubauer et al., 2019).

Interpretivism. Incorporating interpretivism into transcendental phenomenology allows researchers to explore the rich and contextual aspects of lived experiences, acknowledging the influence of interpretation in constructing meaning with consciousness (Neubauer et al., 2019).

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(13) Methodology

This qualitative study will be using transcendental phenomenology as a research design. Fifteen participants will be chosen based on the inclusion criteria: 1) bonafide student of the university, 2) have performed in the Maragtas at least two or more times, and 3) ages 18-25.

Permission from concerned authorities will be done. The researchers will seek assistance from the cultural coordinators of each campus to identify potential participants. Before data collection, the interview guide will be reviewed by a panel of experts composed of an educational research professor, a language expert, and tourism and cultural affairs officers.

Participants will be trained on the steps for using photovoice. Guidelines for photovoice:

- *Photovoice should be a participatory, collaborative process from the beginning.*
- *Participants and staff need training.*
- *Participants need support.*
- *The project should result in some action.*

Conducting a photovoice requires these steps:

1. Recruit participants, at least one mentor/facilitator, and staff/volunteers
2. Plan the project with the group you are working with
3. Train participants, staff, and/or volunteers on technicalities of photography and ethical and safe photography
4. Taking photos
5. Discussing, reflecting, and choosing photos
6. Exhibition of photographs

In-depth interviews will be done with the participants. All interviews will be audio recorded and later transcribed for coding purposes. Following the transcription, a copy of each transcribed interview will be e-mailed to the corresponding participant for member checking. This will allow participants to review their responses and clarify or elaborate on any points made during the interview. For clarification purposes, participants will be asked to email any changes made to the transcription to the researcher within a week of receiving the transcription.

Data analysis will follow Van Kaam's guidelines for organizing and analyzing data of transcendental phenomenology (Creswell & Creswell, 2017). The steps that will be followed include: 1) bracketing – suspend preconceptions and biases to approach data without predetermined ideas, 2) data reduction – condense the data essential elements while preserving its meaning, 3) clustering – identify patterns or themes in the data, 4) textural description – provide detailed description of the lived experience based on the data, 5) structural description – extract underlying structures and relationships within the data, 6) composite description – synthesize the textural and structural descriptions into a comprehensive understanding of the phenomenon, and 7) validation – confirm findings through member checking or peer review to enhance the credibility of the analysis.

The research will be conducted with integrity and honesty. Once student participants are identified, participant-informed assent/consent forms will be obtained along with parental consent. Participant-informed assent/consent forms would inform potential participants about the study and inform them about their rights as participants (Creswell, 2013). Participation will be voluntary and could end at any time throughout the study. Pseudonyms will be used throughout this study to protect the identity of the student participants.

This study will follow Lincoln and Guba's (1986) model for establishing trustworthiness by focusing on credibility, dependability, transferability, and confirmability.

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The researchers are faculty members of the university who are handling language, literature, and cultural-related courses. They have a common advocacy in promoting and preserving language and culture in the academe and the local communities.

(14) Major Activities/Work plan (Enumerate in chronological order the task to be undertaken. Use gantt chart.

Work Plan

Research Activities	Mar	Apr	May	Jun	Jul	Aug	Sep	Oct	Nov	Dec	Jan
1. Gathering and reading materials connected to the study of interest											
2. Writing of Proposal/Instrument Development											
3. Data Collection											
4. Analysis of data											
5. Writing research report											
6. Report presentation/dissemination											
7. Publication											

(15) Expected Output (Indicate the specific products, processes or services which the project is expected to produce; quantify when possible)
Published journal article

(15) Technology Transfer Activity Design (Indicate the specific products, activity design, processes or services to be transferred as extension activities)

(16) Target Beneficiaries (Who the clientele are and what are the expected outcome/effects of the use of the projects output)
The study is expected to significantly influence how faculty members, information specialists/librarians, instructional materials committees, curriculum planners, and administrators develop educational and information systems best to serve the needs of the academic and scientific communities.

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(17) Personnel Requirement

Name	Role Program, Project, Study Leader)	Field of Specialization
CAPSU Team		
1. Dr. Louis Placido F. Lachica	Study Leader	DevCom/English

Percent time devoted to the Program/ Project/ Study

Program/Project Leader (in hours):

Program/Project Members (in hours):

SOURCES OF EXPENSES	Quantity	Amount (Php)
A. Fieldwork/Data Collection		
- Survey Expenses		Php 15,000.00
B. Documentation, photocopy, and printing expenses Photo developing		10,000.00
C. Photo exhibit expenses		10,000.00
D. Conference presentation expenses		15,000.00
E. Publication Expenses		50,000.00
TOTAL		100,000.00

(19) Literature Cited (include only those references published in reputable journals, and at least that from CAPSU Research Journal, <http://researchjournal.capsu.edu.ph/>)

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(20) Capsule Curriculum Vitae (One-page brief C.V. only)